

Escalation Support for Educators



Rung 1 of 10
Immediate Safety

Clear the escalated zone.
Give the silent signal (tap your own head) to bring in a second educator for anyone scared or hurt.

Did you need to signal for backup today?

What happened?

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Is this play schema (trajectory), attachment-seeking, safety-seeking, or sensory-seeking? Use E.A.S.E. to check.

What did you decide was driving it?

Rung 2 of 10
Recognise the Driver



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Rung 3 of 10
Narrate It

"I can see that..." Name what you see, no correction yet.

What did you say to them?

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Beanbags into a basket, pushing a block cart, squeezing wet sponges.
Minimal words, no lecture.

Which redirect did you offer?

Did the child engage in your direction?

Rung 4 of 10
Redirect the Outlet



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Is their arousal settling with the
redirect, or still high?

What did their body tell you?

Rung 5 of 10
Read the Body



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Still high: another high-arousal joint-attention activity. Coming down: a mid-arousal joint-attention stepping stone.

Which path did you take?

What did you notice after taking this path?



Rung 6 of 10
Branch by Arousal

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Rung 7 of 10
Loop the Check-In

Check both the arousal level and
body responses of both the child
and yourself.

Has anything shifted?

How were you both doing at this
check-in?

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Notice the features and sensory feelings of the environment together. Help children notice their body responses too.

What did you notice, together?

Rung 8 of 10
Senses Check



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If they can't notice their own body yet, narrate it for them: "Your hands are clenched, your chest is moving fast."

What did you say to the child?

Rung 9 of 10
Commentate the Body

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Both educators come back together. Share what each child's body needed. Stay pro-child, not annoyed.

What did you both notice, and agree to try next time?

Rung 10 of 10
Reunite and Debrief

